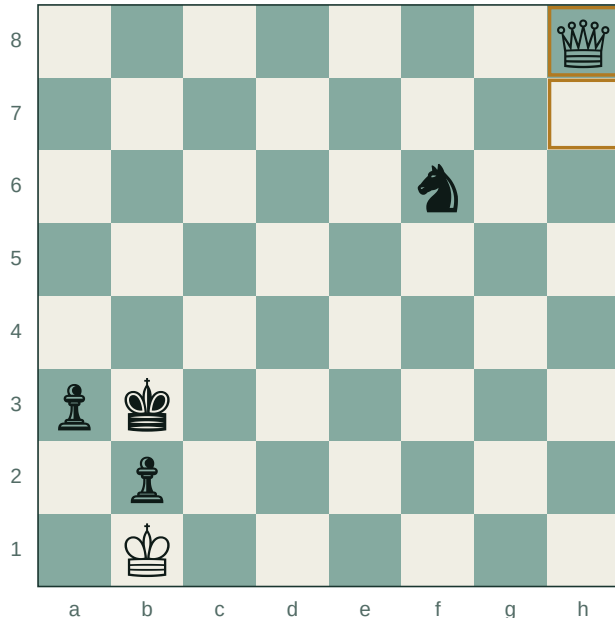


Advanced-pawn tactics: Black, move 56

Advanced-pawn tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 56.h8=Q. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

56...a2#

56...a2# Mate: pawn on a2 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on b1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Pawn on a2. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A far-advanced pawn may be weak if unsupported. Check whether the opponent can capture it with tempo or blockade it permanently.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pawn near promotion forces the defender to respect urgent threats. Its strength can create forks, deflections, or mating ideas even when it never actually promotes.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the remaining pushes and identify the blocker. Look for forcing moves that remove or distract that blocker.

The defending king is on b1. Geometrically undefended: queen on h8. Check for tactical protection.